



Estd:1997

Email: st_anns_coll@yahoo.co.in

ST. ANN'S COLLEGE FOR WOMEN

Run by The Society of St Anne

Affiliated to Acharya Nagarjuna University, Approved by AICTE

Recognised under Section 2(f) of the UGC Act 1956, New Delhi.

Accredited by NAAC with 'A' Grade in the first cycle

Amaravathi Road, Gorantla, Guntur-34, Andhra Pradesh, India.



Website: www.stannscollegeforwomen.ac.in

Institutional Innovation Cell (IIC)

ANNUAL ACTIVITY REPORT

Academic Year 2025–2026

1. Introduction

The Institutional Innovation Cell (IIC) of St. Ann's College for Women, Gorantla, Guntur was established with the objective of promoting a culture of innovation, creativity, entrepreneurship, problem-solving, intellectual property awareness, and start-up development among students and faculty members.

The Cell provides a platform for students to identify real-life problems, develop innovative ideas, acquire entrepreneurial skills, interact with experts and industry professionals, and explore opportunities for converting innovative ideas into viable products, services, projects, or start-ups.

During the academic year 2025–2026, the IIC continued its efforts to strengthen the institutional ecosystem for innovation and entrepreneurship through awareness programmes, expert interactions, student activities, skill development initiatives, idea-generation activities, and coordination with various institutional cells and departments.

2. Objectives of the Institutional Innovation Cell

The major objectives of the IIC during the academic year were:

1. To create awareness about innovation, creativity and entrepreneurship among students and faculty.
2. To encourage students to develop innovative and problem-solving ideas.
3. To promote design thinking and idea development.
4. To create awareness regarding Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), patents, copyrights and trademarks.
5. To motivate students towards entrepreneurship and start-up development.

6. To facilitate interaction with entrepreneurs, industry experts, innovators and professionals.
 7. To encourage participation in innovation and entrepreneurship-related competitions and programmes.
 8. To identify promising student ideas and provide opportunities for further mentoring and development.
 9. To promote women entrepreneurship and self-employment.
 10. To strengthen collaboration among the IIC, IQAC, Entrepreneurship Development Cell, IPR Cell, departments and other institutional bodies.
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3. Major Areas of Activities

During 2025–2026, the Institutional Innovation Cell focused on the following areas:

- Innovation and creativity awareness
- Design thinking and problem-solving
- Entrepreneurship awareness
- Start-up and business idea development
- Intellectual Property Rights awareness
- Patent and copyright awareness
- Industry and expert interaction
- Student idea generation
- Skill development
- Innovation competitions and presentations
- Mentoring and guidance
- Women entrepreneurship
- Social and community-oriented innovation
- Technology-enabled innovation
- Sustainable and environment-friendly solutions

4. Activities Conducted During the Academic Year 2025–2026

4.1 Innovation and Entrepreneurship Awareness Programmes

The IIC organised awareness-oriented activities to introduce students to the concepts of innovation, entrepreneurship, start-ups and self-employment. Students were encouraged to think creatively, identify problems in society and explore innovative solutions.

The programmes highlighted the importance of developing an entrepreneurial mindset and encouraged students to consider entrepreneurship as a career option.

Major outcomes:

- Increased awareness of innovation and entrepreneurship.
- Encouragement for students to think beyond conventional career pathways.
- Promotion of creativity and independent thinking.

4.2 Design Thinking and Problem-Solving Activities

Students were encouraged to understand real-world problems and develop possible solutions using a **design-thinking and problem-solving approach**.

Activities focused on:

- Identification of problems
- Understanding user needs
- Idea generation
- Brainstorming
- Evaluation of innovative solutions
- Prototype and solution development

These activities helped students improve their analytical, creative and collaborative skills.

4.3 Expert / Entrepreneur Interaction

The Cell encouraged interaction between students and experienced professionals, entrepreneurs and subject experts.

The interactions provided students with practical exposure to:

- Starting a business
- Identifying business opportunities
- Developing innovative ideas
- Understanding market requirements
- Financial planning
- Risk management
- Challenges faced by entrepreneurs
- Opportunities for women entrepreneurs

Students were encouraged to seek guidance from experts for developing their ideas and career plans.

4.4 Intellectual Property Rights Awareness

In coordination with the **IPR Cell**, awareness was promoted regarding the importance of protecting innovative ideas and intellectual creations.

Students and faculty members were sensitized to:

- Patents
- Copyrights
- Trademarks
- Intellectual property
- Patentable innovations
- Importance of documentation
- Commercialization of innovative ideas

The initiative helped create awareness about the relationship between innovation and intellectual property protection.

4.5 Student Idea Generation and Innovation Activities

The IIC encouraged students to identify innovative ideas relating to academic, social, environmental and community needs.

Students were motivated to work on ideas related to:

- Technology
- Education
- Environment
- Health and hygiene
- Women empowerment
- Sustainable development
- Digital solutions
- Social problems
- Local community needs

Students were encouraged to present and discuss their ideas with faculty mentors.

4.6 Entrepreneurship Development Activities

The Cell promoted entrepreneurship as a viable career option for students, particularly in the context of **women entrepreneurship**.

Students were encouraged to explore opportunities in:

- Small businesses
- Home-based enterprises
- Digital entrepreneurship
- Service enterprises
- Technology-based start-ups
- Social entrepreneurship
- Skill-based enterprises

The activities aimed to develop confidence, initiative, leadership and self-employment skills.

4.7 Innovation and Start-up Orientation

Students were introduced to the basic stages involved in transforming an idea into a start-up:

Problem Identification → Idea Generation → Validation → Prototype → Business Model → Market Analysis → Funding → Start-up Development

The Cell encouraged students to understand the importance of market needs, customer requirements, feasibility and sustainability before developing an enterprise.

4.8 Competitions and Student Participation

Students were encouraged to participate in innovation-related:

- Idea competitions
- Poster presentations
- Quiz programmes
- Essay writing
- Project exhibitions
- Pitching activities
- Innovation challenges
- Entrepreneurship competitions

Such activities provided students with opportunities to demonstrate creativity, communication and presentation skills.

4.9 Faculty Sensitization and Capacity Building

The IIC also encouraged faculty members to participate in programmes related to:

- Innovation
 - Entrepreneurship
 - IPR
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- Design thinking
- Mentoring
- Start-up ecosystem
- Innovation management

Faculty members were encouraged to act as mentors and facilitators for student innovation activities.

4.10 Collaboration with Institutional Cells

The Institutional Innovation Cell worked in coordination with other institutional bodies, particularly:

- IQAC
- Entrepreneurship Development / Innovation & Start-up Committee
- IPR Cell
- Research & Development Cell
- Career Guidance & Placement Cell
- NSS
- NCC
- Academic Departments

This collaborative approach helped integrate innovation, research, entrepreneurship and employability initiatives within the institution.

5. Student Engagement

Students from different academic disciplines were encouraged to participate in innovation and entrepreneurship activities.

The multidisciplinary participation provided opportunities for students from **Commerce, Computer Science, BCA, Mathematics, Physics, Statistics, Biotechnology, Microbiology, Botany, Chemistry and other disciplines** to share ideas and explore innovative solutions.

The Cell particularly encouraged students to identify problems from their academic and community environment and develop practical solutions.

6. Major Outcomes

The activities of the Institutional Innovation Cell during 2025–2026 contributed to:

- Creating an **innovation-oriented culture** on campus.
 - Increasing student awareness of entrepreneurship and start-ups.
 - Encouraging creative and critical thinking.
 - Promoting problem-solving and design-thinking skills.
 - Creating awareness about Intellectual Property Rights.
 - Encouraging students to explore self-employment opportunities.
 - Promoting women entrepreneurship.
 - Strengthening interaction with experts and professionals.
 - Encouraging interdisciplinary collaboration.
 - Providing mentoring opportunities for innovative student ideas.
 - Supporting the institution's quality enhancement and innovation initiatives.
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7. Best Practices Adopted

The following practices were encouraged during the year:

1. **Student-centric innovation activities**
 2. **Learning through problem identification and solution development**
 3. **Interdisciplinary participation**
 4. **Expert and entrepreneur interaction**
 5. **Integration of innovation with academic learning**
 6. **IPR awareness alongside innovation**
 7. **Promotion of women entrepreneurship**
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8. **Mentoring of promising student ideas**
 9. **Promotion of sustainable and socially relevant innovations**
 10. **Documentation of innovation-related activities for institutional quality enhancement**
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8. Future Plan

The Institutional Innovation Cell proposes to further strengthen its activities by:

- Conducting regular innovation and entrepreneurship awareness programmes.
 - Organising design-thinking and ideation workshops.
 - Developing a structured student idea repository.
 - Providing systematic mentoring for innovative ideas.
 - Encouraging prototype development.
 - Strengthening industry interaction.
 - Promoting student start-up initiatives.
 - Conducting IPR and patent awareness programmes.
 - Encouraging participation in innovation challenges and competitions.
 - Exploring incubation and funding opportunities.
 - Promoting collaborations with entrepreneurs, industries and innovation organisations.
 - Strengthening women entrepreneurship initiatives.
 - Encouraging sustainable and socially impactful innovations.
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9. Conclusion

The **Institutional Innovation Cell of St. Ann's College for Women, Gorantla, Guntur**, played an important role in promoting **innovation, creativity, entrepreneurship and intellectual property awareness** during the academic year **2025–2026**.

Through awareness programmes, mentoring, expert interaction, idea-generation activities and collaborative initiatives, the Cell encouraged students to develop an innovative mindset and explore entrepreneurship as a career opportunity.

The IIC remains committed to creating a vibrant institutional ecosystem where **ideas are encouraged, creativity is nurtured, innovation is recognised, and students are empowered to become confident entrepreneurs, innovators and responsible contributors to society.**

Prepared by:

Institutional Innovation Cell (IIC)

St. Ann's College for Women

Gorantla, Guntur, Andhra Pradesh

Academic Year: 2025–2026